PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Prenatal Massage

Follow your prenatal training, state board rules and the client's provider guidance. Times for 60 minutes.

SCREEN

Intake, weeks and due date noted. Any high-risk factor: written clearance first.

CHECK TODAY

Ask about bleeding, cramping, headaches or swelling. Any warning sign: refer.

PRE-SESSION

Book from [13] weeks per policy. Light snack and restroom before the session.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Hands washed ☐ Fresh linens and covers ☐ Pillows, bolsters, wedge ready ☐ Nut-free, unscented lotion ☐ Room warm, not hot ☐ Water within reach

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Check-in & consent**	5 min	Review changes and warning signs. Clearance on file if needed.
2	**Position**	3 min	Side-lying with pillows, or semi-reclined with a left tilt.
3	**Back & hips**	12 min	Light to moderate effleurage, petrissage. Glutes only with consent.
4	**Neck & shoulders**	8 min	Slow strokes on upper trapezius and back of neck. No anterior neck.
5	**Legs**	6 min	Light strokes toward the heart. No deep inner leg or calf work.
6	**Turn & repeat**	12 min	Assist a slow roll, reset bolsters, repeat back, hips and shoulders.
7	**Arms & hands**	4 min	Gentle strokes toward the heart. Very light over swollen hands.
8	**Feet**	3 min	Broad, gentle strokes. No sustained deep pressure at the ankles.
9	**Abdomen (optional)**	2 min	Only if requested: feather-light strokes. Never deep abdominal work.
10	**Rise slowly**	3 min	Roll to side, push up, sit a moment. Check for dizziness.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	2 min	Review sheet and card. Record session. Rebook at [2–4] weeks.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Never flat on the back after about 20 weeks
- Essential oils minimal; unscented default
- No prone unless approved cushion [policy]
- Post C-section: provider clearance, [6] weeks

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Bleeding, leaking fluid, contractions: stop; client calls provider now.
- Calf pain, warmth or one-sided swelling: no leg work; urgent care.
- Heartburn or hip pain: raise the head, adjust the bolsters.
- Severe headache, vision changes, sudden swelling: stop; call provider.
- Dizziness or nausea: left side, pause, water. End if it persists.
- Chest pain, trouble breathing or fainting: call 911.

Write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Weeks · due date	Position used	Clearance (Y · N · n/a)	Pressure (1–5)
Areas avoided	**Swelling · notes**	**Reaction or none**	**Next visit · initials**